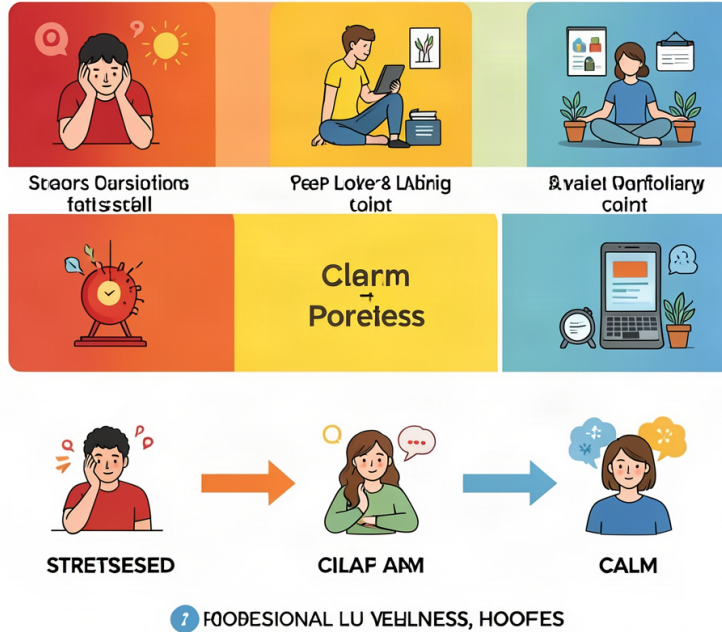


CALM-DOWN PLAN

PROFESSIONAL WELLNESS GUIDE



Calm-Down Plan

Turn helpful ideas into clear steps for emotionally intense moments

Create a simple personal sequence to follow before, during, and after a difficult moment.

Calm-Down Plan

Children with a trusted adult, teens, adults, families and classrooms

Make the plan while you are calm

A calm-down plan works best when it is simple, visible, and practiced ahead of time. Choose steps that are safe, specific, and possible in the places where you usually need them.

How to use this tool

Work through the pages in any order. Use a pen, pencil, or digital annotation tool. Keep what helps; leave what does not.

Important

This is not an emergency or suicide-safety plan. If there is immediate danger, self-harm risk, violence, or inability to stay safe, contact emergency services or an appropriate crisis resource immediately.

Know my early signals

Body signs

Examples: tight jaw, fast heart, hot face, shaky hands

Thought signs

Examples: everything is ruined, nobody understands, I have to leave

Behavior signs

Examples: raising my voice, withdrawing, rushing, arguing

My traffic-light plan

Green: steady

My regular supports: sleep, food, movement, connection, routines.

Yellow: building

Pause. Use one tool. Move to a calmer space if possible. Let someone know.

Red: overwhelmed

Leave danger. Contact support. Follow the safety or emergency plan if needed.

My first three steps

Keep the sequence short enough to remember.

1. When I notice my signs, I will...

2. I will move to / use...

3. If I still need help, I will contact...

Words I can use: I need a quiet break / Please stay nearby / I am not ready to discuss this.

After the moment

Reflection is for learning, not blame.

What helped?

What made it harder?

What repair or follow-up is needed?

One change I will make before the next difficult moment

Sources and use note

This printable tool was designed with general self-care and coping concepts from the sources below. It is educational material, not health care or therapy.

National Institute of Mental Health: Caring for Your Mental Health

Self-care, connection, stress-management framing

<https://www.nimh.nih.gov/health/topics/caring-for-your-mental-health>

National Institute of Mental Health: So Stressed Out

Journaling, relaxation, mindfulness, sleep, and support concepts

<https://www.nimh.nih.gov/health/publications/so-stressed-out-fact-sheet>

NHS: Breathing exercises for stress

Comfortable, unforced breathing guidance

<https://www.nhs.uk/mental-health/self-help/guides-tools-and-activities/breathing-exercises-for-stress/>

WebMD: What Is Box Breathing?

Optional paced-breathing presentation

<https://www.webmd.com/balance/what-is-box-breathing>

WebMD: Quick Stress-Relief Rituals

Sensory grounding context

<https://www.webmd.com/depression/quick-stress-relief-rituals>

American Psychological Association: Stress management tips

Thought, emotion, behavior, and reframing context

<https://www.apa.org/topics/stress/tips>

CASEL: Fundamentals of SEL

Emotion identification and self-management framing

<https://casel.org/fundamentals-of-sel/>

CDC: Information for Family Caregivers

Caregiver capacity, breaks, and support framing

<https://www.cdc.gov/disability-and-health/about/information-for-family-caregivers.html>

Child Mind Institute: How to Help Children Calm Down

Coping-ahead and child-friendly calming support

<https://childmind.org/article/how-to-help-children-calm-down/>

Wikipedia: Mindfulness

Plain-language background only; not clinical authority

<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Mindfulness>

Reddit community discussions

User-centered presentation inspiration only; not clinical authority

https://www.reddit.com/r/Anxiety/comments/1ch67c8/making_an_anxiety_tool_box_what_should_i_put_in_it/

YouTube guided box-breathing example

Visual pacing inspiration only; not clinical authority

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tEmt1Znux58>